

Defense Brief

August 29, 2026



Bangladesh Moves Toward \$2.3B
Chinese J-10CE Fighter Deal as
Seoul Nuclear Debate Swells to 65%
Support

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The Bottom Line

Today's defense picture is defined by procurement decisions and political signals rather than a single headline event. Bangladesh's advance toward a \$2.3 billion Chinese J-10CE deal — citing last year's India-Pakistan clashes — shows Beijing's combat-flavored hardware, and its marketing after Operation Sindoor, is gaining buyers across South Asia. In the alliance sphere, Poland's government publicly split over whether to host US nuclear warheads just as Washington's NATO 3.0 review pushes Europe to lead its own defense, while a Gallup poll found 65 percent of South Koreans now favor an indigenous nuclear arsenal amid reduced US drill posture. The US poured a record \$76.6 billion into new submarines as its GAO warns the existing fleet is losing operational days faster than the yards can fix them, and India moved closer to a \$9 billion German submarine deal even as Berlin wrestles with its own ballooning frigate costs. The through-line: demand for capable, affordable and politically sustainable defense is reshaping procurement in both hemispheres — from reusable jet interceptors on the Ukrainian frontline to the nuclear debates now opening in Warsaw and Seoul.